

KING COUNTY PLAY EQUITY COALITION · 2027

Every kid deserves a place to play.

The King County Play Equity Report

Research by the University of Washington Center for Leadership in Athletics
Guided by the Community Advisory Board

INTERACTIVE PDF · SAMPLE EDITION FOR DESIGN REVIEW · SAMPLE DATA WHERE MARKED

CONTENTS

Inside this report

00 Where we started 3

01 Who's playing — and who isn't 4

02 What gets in the way 5

03 Places to play 6

04 Youth voice 7

05 What we do next 8

— How we did this 9

01
02
03
04
05
☰

How to use this interactive PDF

- **Click any chapter** on this page or the colored tabs on the right edge of every page.
- **"Explore this data" buttons** open the matching live dashboard, where you can filter by age, gender, region, income and language.
- Tap ☰ to return to these contents.

Read online, explore the data, watch the videos: **kc-play-equity-report.pplx.app**

WHERE WE STARTED

In 2019, King County earned a D for getting kids active.

The first *State of Play Seattle–King County* surveyed and interviewed more than 1,600 local adults and young people. It found that barely one in five youth got the recommended hour of daily activity — and that girls, youth of color, youth with disabilities and youth who don't speak English at home were less active still. This report asks what has changed.

19%

of King County youth met the CDC's 60-minutes-a-day activity guideline

D

grade given to Seattle–King County for getting youth active

13%

of youth never joined organized sport because of cost

~3×

more likely to have never played if English isn't spoken at home

2019 baseline, published. Sources: Aspen Institute, *State of Play Seattle–King County* (aspeninstitute.org); Seattle Parks Foundation; Seattle Parks & Recreation Strategic Plan (2020).

> **"Instead of paying $1,500 to $2,000 for one season, I can buy a $300–$400 Xbox and a PlayStation, and my kid will be at home safe."**
>
> Parent, State of Play focus group · published by KCPEC

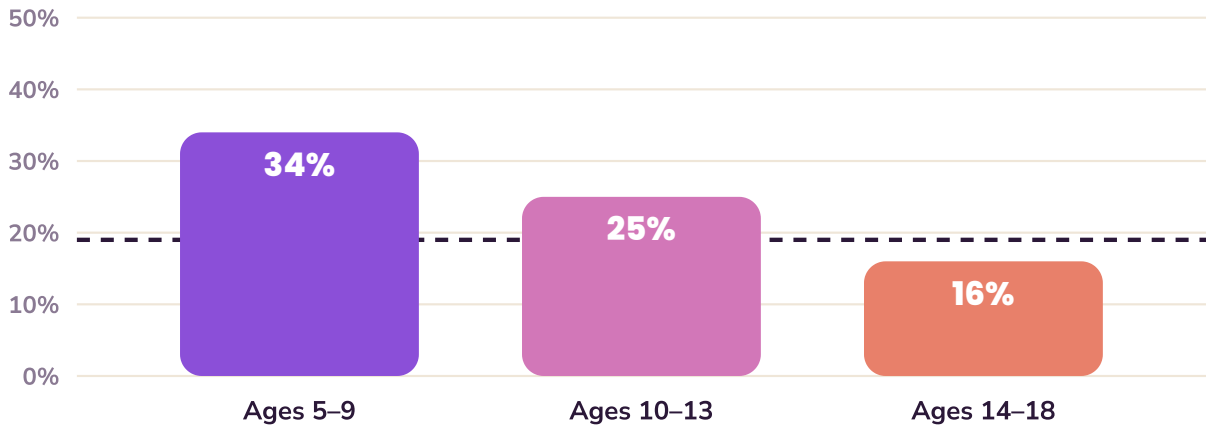
CHAPTER 01

Who's playing — and who isn't

Activity drops sharply as kids get older. The steepest fall comes between middle school and high school — exactly when sport costs and travel demands rise.

Youth meeting 60 minutes of activity a day, by age · dashed line = 2019 baseline (19%)

SAMPLE DATA



Explore this data by gender, income, region & language →

Top 5 sports youth played in the past year

SAMPLE DATA



See the top 10 sports & filter by group →

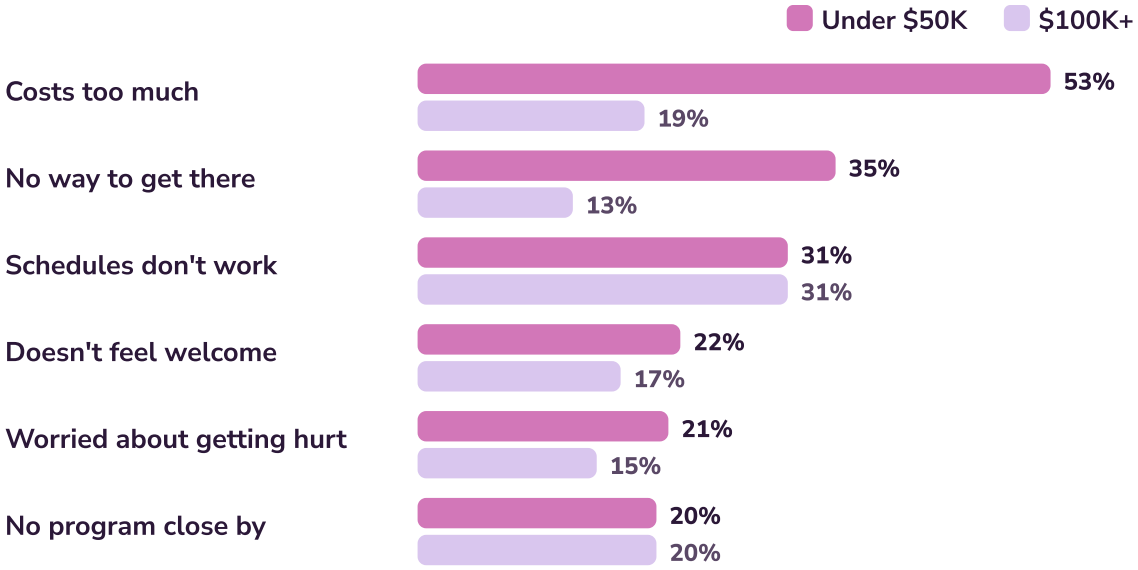
CHAPTER 02

What gets in the way



Families named the same barriers again and again: cost, getting there, schedules that don't fit working parents, and not feeling like a program was meant for them.

Top reasons youth don't play, by household income SAMPLE DATA



Explore barriers for every group →

CHAPTER 03

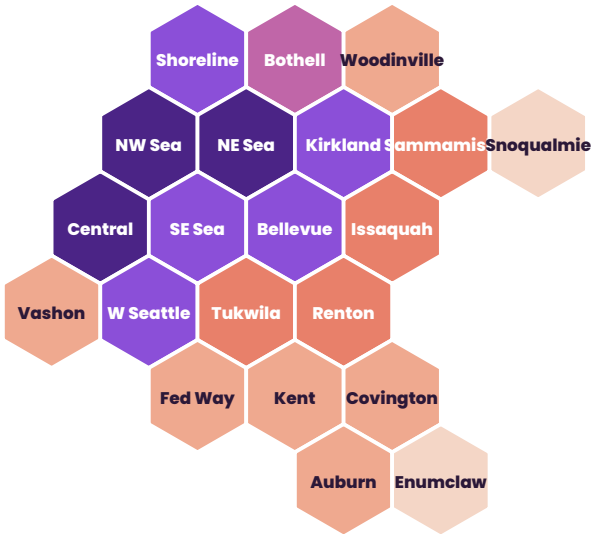
Places to play



King County has world-class outdoor space, but it isn't evenly shared. Fields are booked by travel teams, and South King County and rural areas have fewer low-cost programs per child.

Youth within a 10-minute walk of a park or field

SAMPLE DATA



46%

Des Moines / Federal Way

Youth within a 10-minute walk of a park — county average 59%.

95%

Central & Downtown Seattle

Highest access in the county.

Open the interactive access map →

CHAPTER 04

Youth voice



Young people told us the best part of sport is having fun with friends. Through Youth Action Mapping, they also showed us — block by block — what helps and what gets in the way.

> **"We mapped every court within a mile of school. Half had no nets."**
>
> Youth Action Mapping team member · sample quote

Open the Youth Action Map →

Community Advisory Board, in their own voices







Watch the Advisory Board videos →

CHAPTER 05

What we do next

Each recommendation names who can act, so every reader can find the part that belongs to them.

01

Make the first season free

FUNDERS · PARKS

02

Open the gates for free play

PARKS · SCHOOLS

03

Get kids there

TRANSIT · SCHOOLS

04

Train every coach for belonging

COACHES · FUNDERS

05

Speak families' languages

PARKS · COMMUNITY ORGS

06

Keep listening to youth

COALITION · YOUTH

> **"Coaches are the front door to sport. Train us and the door stays open."**
>
> Youth coach, stakeholder interview · sample quote

Sample recommendations shown to demonstrate layout. Final recommendations come from the Coalition and UW research team.

Read the full recommendations online →

HOW WE DID THIS

Four ways of listening.

Parents
Statewide parent survey, King County sample

35
Stakeholder interviews

Groups
Community focus groups

Youth
Youth survey & Youth Action Mapping

Protecting the people who shared their stories

- Only aggregated, de-identified results are published.
- Any result based on fewer than 10 people is suppressed.
- Quotes, photos and videos appear only with documented consent.

KEEP EXPLORING

Filter the data. Watch the videos. Read the youth map.

Visit the full report online →

Concept edition prepared by The Data Guys for the Play Equity Report design subcommittee. Sample data is illustrative only and will be replaced with final UW analysis.